

Yinuo (Nancy) Xu

PHD STUDENT · UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN SCHOOL OF INFORMATION

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Education

University of Michigan

PHD IN INFORMATION

- Advisor: David Jurgens

Ann Arbor, MI

2023 – Present

University of California, Berkeley

B.A. IN DATA SCIENCE, B.A. IN STATISTICS

Berkeley, CA

Spring 2023

Professional Experience

2024 – Graduate Research Assistant with Professor David Jurgens, UMSI

2023 – Graduate Research Assistant with Professors David Jurgens, Allison Earl, and Veronica Derricks, UMSI and LSA Social Psychology

2022 - 2023 Undergraduate Research Assistant, UC Berkeley School of Information

2021 - 2023 Undergraduate Research Assistant with Professor Zachary Pardos, UC Berkeley School of Education

2021 - 2023 Undergraduate Research Assistant with Professor Heather Haveman, UC Berkeley Department of Sociology

2021 Data Science Intern, NLP, Evisort

Publications

PUBLISHED

Xu, Y., Chen, H., Rakshit, S., Ananthasubramaniam, A., Yadav, O., Zheng, M., Jiang, M., Zhang, L., Yi, B., Alkiek, K., Israeli, A., Shu, B., Shen, H., Pei, J., Zhang, H., Schirmer, M., & Jurgens, D. (2025). Causally modeling the linguistic and social factors that predict email response. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Nations of the Americas Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies (Volume 1: Long Papers)* (pp. 11842–11866). Association for Computational Linguistics. <https://aclanthology.org/2025.naacl-long.594/>

* Authors contributed equally.

Borchers, C., **Xu, Y.**, & Pardos, Z. A. (2025). Workload Overload? Late Enrollment Leads to Course Dropout. *Journal of Educational Data Mining*, 17(1), 126–156. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.14907388>

Borchers, C., **Xu, Y.**, & Pardos, Z. A. (2024). Are You an Early Dropper or Late Shopper? Mining Enrollment Transaction Data to Study Procrastination in Higher Education. In B. Paaßen & C. Demmans Epp (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 17th International Conference on Educational Data Mining* (pp. 426–433). International Educational Data Mining Society. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.12729852>

Xu, Y., & Pardos, Z. A. (2024). Extracting course similarity signal using subword embeddings. In *The 14th Learning Analytics and Knowledge Conference (LAK '24)*, March 18–22, 2024, Kyoto, Japan (pp. 1–7). ACM. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3636555.3636903>

Xu, Y., & Pardos, Z. A. (2023). Mining detailed course transaction records for semantic information. *Proceedings of the 16th International Conference on Educational Data Mining*, 388–395. International Educational Data Mining Society.

IN REVIEW

Xu, Y., Derricks, V., Earl, A., & Jurgens, D. (2025). Modeling annotator disagreement with demographic-aware experts and synthetic perspectives. *arXiv*. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2508.02853>

Haber, J. R., Haveman, H. A., & **Xu, Y.** (2024). Toward Computational Literature Reviews: Analyzing Academic Theories through Supervised and Unsupervised Text-Analysis Methods. <https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/e35vn>

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2023 **UMSI Merit fellowship**, UMSI

Teaching Experience

Spring 2023 **Natural Language Processing (Info 159/259)**, Teaching Assistant, UC Berkeley School of Information

Fall 2022 **Principles and Techniques of Data Science (Data 100/200)**, Undergraduate Student Instructor

Summer 2022 **Principles and Techniques of Data Science (Data 100/200)**, Undergraduate Student Instructor

Spring 2023 **Technology and Social Impact (EECS 198)**, Lead Facilitator

Research Experience

UMSI

Ann Arbor, MI

ADVISOR: PROFESSOR DAVID JURGENS

Dec. 2024 – Present

- Project: Modeling Annotator Disagreements

UMSI and LSA Social Psychology

Ann Arbor, MI

SUPERVISORS: PROFESSORS DAVID JURGENS, ALLISON EARL, AND VERONICA DERRICKS

Aug. 2023 – Present

- Project: Measuring Racial Disparity in the Language of Doctor-Patient Conversations

UC Berkeley School of Information

Berkeley, CA

SUPERVISOR: DR. SANDEEP SONI

Sept. 2022 – May 2023

- Researched and developed statistical tests to detect semantic variation and change using contextual and non-contextual NLP methods.

UC Berkeley School of Education

Berkeley, CA

ADVISOR: PROFESSOR ZACHARY PARDOS

Sept. 2021 – May 2023

- Projects: Mining detailed course transaction records for semantic information, Extracting course similarity signal using sub-word embeddings

UC Berkeley Department of Sociology

Berkeley, CA

ADVISOR: PROFESSOR HEATHER HAVEMAN AND DR. JAREN HABER

Sept. 2021 – May 2023

- Project: Toward Computational Literature Reviews: Analyzing Academic Theories through Supervised and Unsupervised Text-Analysis Methods.